

Firearms Trace Data: Connecticut - 2023

Data Source: Firearms Tracing System

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

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ATF Firearms Trace Data Disclaimer

Firearm traces are designed to assist law enforcement authorities in conducting investigations by tracking the sale and possession of specific firearms. Law enforcement agencies may request firearms traces for any investigative reason, and those reasons are not necessarily reported to the federal government. Not all firearms used in crime are traced and not all firearms traced are used in crime.

Firearms selected for tracing are not chosen for purposes of determining which types, makes or models of firearms are used for illicit purposes. The firearms selected do not constitute a random sample and should not be considered representative of the larger universe of all firearms used by criminals, or any subset of that universe. Firearms are normally traced to the first retail seller, and sources reported for firearms traced do not necessarily represent the sources or methods by which firearms in general are acquired for use in crime.

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced in Connecticut in Calendar Year 2023

2,219

Firearm Types with a Connecticut Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Pistols	1,586
Rifles	234
Revolvers	200
Shotguns	142
Machinegun Conversion Devices	31
Other*	26

* Other includes Derringers, Unknown Types, Machineguns, Receivers/Frames and a Combination.

Top Calibers Reported on Firearm Traces with a Connecticut Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

9mm	953
.40 Cal	202
.22 Cal	180
.45 Cal	149
.380 Cal	128
12GA	108

.38 Cal	86
.357 Cal	45
.223 Cal	33
.25 Cal	25
.32 Cal	25

NOTE: There were 186 additional traces that were associated with other calibers. There were 99 traces with an unknown caliber.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a Connecticut Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Firearm Under Investigation	688
Possession of Weapon	634
Family Offense	210
Found Firearm	185
Weapon Offense	174
Health - Safety	47
Homicide	43
Suicide	34
Dangerous Drugs	26
Simple Assault	23

NOTE: There were 155 additional traces that were associated with other categories.

Top 15 Source States for Firearms with a Connecticut Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Connecticut	696
Georgia	112
Florida	100
South Carolina	86
Vermont	69
North Carolina	60
Virginia	42
Maine	37
Texas	37
New Hampshire	29
Massachusetts	28
Kansas	25
Ohio	23
Alabama	21
Pennsylvania	18
West Virginia	18

NOTE: An additional 29 states, Guam and Puerto Rico accounted for 138 other traces. The source state was identified in 1,539 total traces.

Time-To-Crime Rates for Firearms with a Connecticut Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Under 3 Months	51
3 Months to Under 7 Months	75
7 Months to Under 1 Year	71
1 Year to Under 2 Years	188
2 Years to Under 3 Years	167
3 Years and Over	981

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Connecticut Average Time-to-Crime: **9.58 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Time-to-Crime: **6.76 Years**

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a Connecticut Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

17 and Under	57
18 to 21	176
22 to 24	143
25 to 30	298
31 to 40	435
41 to 50	215
Over 50	414

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Connecticut Average Age of Possessor: **39 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Age of Possessor: **35 Years**

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a Connecticut Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Hartford	389
New Haven	317
Waterbury	193
Bridgeport	137
New Britain	96
Vernon	60
Hamden	59
East Hartford	50
Stratford	40
Meriden	36

NOTE: There were 115 additional municipalities that accounted for 841 other traces. The recovery city could not be determined for one trace.

Analytical Criteria Used to Compile the Enclosed Statistics

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced

- Includes traces with a recovery state of Connecticut. Traces in which the recovery state was not provided were included when the requesting agency state was equal to Connecticut.

- Includes Firearms Recovered and Traced between 1/1/2023 – 12/31/2023 or, if the recovery date was blank, firearms with trace entry dates between 1/1/2023 – 12/31/2023.
- Duplicate traces, Firearms Not Recovered, Gun Buyback and Firearms Turned In are not included in this figure.
- Data was extracted from the Firearms Tracing System (FTS) on April 10, 2024.
- All traces may not have been submitted or completed at the time of this study.

Firearm Types and Calibers with a Connecticut Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a Connecticut Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Source States for Firearms with a Connecticut Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser and the state in which the final dealer is located.

Time-to-Crime Rates for Firearms with a Connecticut Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser.
- Time-to-Crime was calculated for those traces in which the purchase date could be subtracted from the recovery date.

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a Connecticut Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces that provide a possessor and the possessor's date of birth.
- Possessor's age is calculated by subtracting the possessor's date of birth from the recovery date.

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a Connecticut Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces with a recovery city or, if the recovery city was not provided, traces requested by agencies with jurisdiction only within that city.

[View All 2023 Firearms Trace Data](#)

Last updated: December 9, 2024